CoRe-TFM: Journal Selection & Submission Readiness

20 October 2026 | Manuscript: Coherence Is Not Accuracy

Recommendation

First choice: Knowledge-Based Systems (Elsevier). The scope explicitly includes machine-learning methodology and prediction systems. The manuscript is strongest as a reliability and uncertainty-evaluation paper, rather than an algorithm claiming universal accuracy improvement. The publisher lists a 7.6 Impact Factor for the journal.

Ranked journal shortlist

Journal	Fit / 10	Why it fits / key risk
Knowledge-Based Systems	8.8	ML methods and knowledge-based prediction; requires a clear novelty argument.
Information Sciences	8.0	Probability compatibility, uncertainty, intelligent systems; may seek deeper theory.
Neurocomputing	7.6	Learning-system reliability and evaluation; less direct knowledge-fusion emphasis.
Expert Systems with Applications	6.9	Prediction and decision support; limited downstream deployment evidence.
Information Fusion	6.4	Probability fusion and multiview decisions; ambitious without positive fusion novelty.

What the revised paper demonstrates

The ten-dataset fixed-test study contains 160 model configurations. Hard projection improved marginal consistency in 80/80 primary comparisons but increased negative log-likelihood in 67/80. The larger selector was not proven better than simpler alternatives. Six targeted GPU reruns on Car, Nursery, and Diamonds exactly reproduced their archived prediction arrays; new checkpoint-file SHA-256 values are recorded for those reruns.

What remains a limitation

MIC (OpenML data ID 46980) returned HTTP 412 during the independent raw-source lookup, leaving 10/11 OpenML source records independently rehashed. Model-file fingerprints from six new runs do not authenticate all historical loaded weight bytes. Exploratory Holm-adjusted tests do not confirm the hard-repair effect at 0.05; paper language must preserve that nuance.

Before submitting

Publish the approved machine-readable evidence with a stable DOI and update Data Availability. Confirm the precise author/funding/conflict/AI declarations and verify all bibliography entries against original publisher records. Check the currently posted journal guide for authors for highlights, graphical abstracts, page limits, and reporting requirements.

Official publisher scope sources

Knowledge-Based Systems — official scope

Information Sciences — official scope

Neurocomputing — official scope

Expert Systems with Applications — official scope

Information Fusion — official scope

Fit ratings are editorial estimates, not acceptance probabilities. Check current journal metrics, fees, indexing and submission rules before paying or submitting.